

RECOMMEDED READING



A small library for curious minds.

These books explore human behaviour, leadership, creativity and connection. Some come from psychology and neuroscience. Others from leadership, storytelling or just observations about life.

All of them offer a different lens on what it means to live, think and work together as humans.

Thinking, Fast and Slow

Daniel Kahneman

One of the most influential books on human decision-making.

Daniel reveals how much of our thinking happens automatically, shaped by mental shortcuts we rarely notice. Once you see these patterns, it becomes easier to understand why humans make the decisions they do.

Drive

Daniel Pink

For years we believed motivation came mainly from rewards and punishments. Daniel shows that reality is far more interesting. People tend to thrive when they feel a sense of autonomy, the opportunity to improve, and a deeper purpose behind their work.

Atomic Habits

James Clear

Big change rarely happens through dramatic moments. It usually grows from small adjustments repeated over time. James explores how tiny habits shape behaviour and how environments influence the choices we make every day.

The Social Brain

Matthew Lieberman

Modern neuroscience is revealing something fascinating: humans are biologically wired for connection. Matthew explains how belonging, recognition and relationships are not just social preferences but deeply embedded needs in the brain.

Dare to Lead

Brené Brown

Leadership is often associated with certainty and control. But Brene takes a different view... She explores the courage required to lead with honesty, to admit uncertainty, and to have conversations that many people avoid.

Leaders Eat Last

Simon Sinek

Through stories from organisations and the military, Simon looks at what happens when leaders prioritise the wellbeing and safety of their teams. Trust, loyalty and commitment tend to grow in environments where people feel genuinely supported.

The Culture Code

Daniel Coyle

What makes some groups work remarkably well together? Daniel travelled from elite sports teams to film studios and military units looking for the answer. The patterns he discovered reveal how strong cultures are built.

The Fearless Organization

Amy Edmondson

Many organisations say they value openness, yet people often hesitate to speak up. Amy explores why psychological safety matters so much and how environments that welcome questions and learning tend to outperform those driven by fear.

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Bond

Greg Morley

Workplaces are full of expectations about how people should behave. Greg explores how these expectations can create emotional distance, and how stronger connections can transform both leadership and collaboration.

The Art of Gathering

Priya Parker

Meetings, events and workshops often happen by habit rather than intention. Priya invites us to rethink how gatherings are designed and how thoughtful structure can create more meaningful interactions.

Daily Rituals

Mason Currey

Mason collected the daily routines of writers, artists, scientists and other creative thinkers. What emerges is a surprisingly simple truth: creative work often grows from steady rhythms, habits and small acts of discipline.

Stronger Ground

Brené Brown

A reflective book about staying grounded when life feels uncertain or overwhelming. Brene explores the small practices that help people reconnect with themselves and move forward with clarity.

The Social Animal

David Brooks

Rather than presenting theory alone, David tells the story of a fictional life to explore how relationships, emotions and environments shape who we become.

Man's Search for Meaning

Viktor Frankl

Written after surviving Nazi concentration camps, Viktor's reflections explore the human search for meaning. Even in the most extreme conditions, the question of purpose remained central to how people endured.

Humankind: A Hopeful History

Rutger Bregman

Are humans naturally selfish? Rutger revisits famous psychological experiments and historical events to challenge that assumption. His argument is simple but powerful: cooperation and kindness may be far more natural than we think.

Sweet Bean Paste

Durian Sukegawa

Set in a small Japanese bakery, this novel tells a quiet story about dignity, patience and seeing people beyond their labels. Sometimes the most powerful lessons about humanity appear in the simplest moments.

The Comfort Book

Matt Haig

A collection of reflections about hope, perspective and emotional resilience. It reads less like a traditional book and more like a companion during difficult days.

The Boy, the Mole, the Fox and the Horse

Charlie Mackesy

Through simple drawings and conversations, Charlie explores friendship, vulnerability and kindness. The story feels almost like a reminder about the things that matter most.

Quiet

Susan Cain

Modern workplaces often celebrate constant visibility and confidence. Susan invites us to reconsider the value of quieter qualities such as reflection, deep thinking and careful listening.

 This list reflects some of the ideas that have shaped the wider conversation about humans, work and leadership. It will continue to grow over time. 

